

Maria Silva

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12 September 2026

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Paralegal role at Global University Systems because the in-house legal context genuinely interests me, and my background in case management, document review, legal research and client-facing advice maps directly onto what the role requires.

At Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner, I spent a year supporting complex disputes across international arbitration and real estate litigation. In arbitration, I reviewed and organised evidence, amended sections of a claimant's memorial, drafted procedural orders and procedural histories, and coordinated documents across an international team under significant deadline pressure. When I became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a major submission, I tracked outstanding actions across multiple workstreams and helped ensure the filing went out on time. That experience gave me a clear picture of what organised, deadline-driven case management actually looks like in practice.

Since July 2026, I have been advising clients at Citizens Advice East Berkshire on welfare, housing, employment and debt matters. Each matter involves taking detailed factual statements, identifying the relevant legal issues, drafting correspondence, preparing document schedules and maintaining confidential case records from instruction through to submission. Translating complex procedural rules into clear, practical guidance for people in difficult circumstances has sharpened my ability to communicate legal issues accessibly, which I expect would be useful in an in-house team dealing with colleagues and stakeholders who are not legally trained.

My academic work is also relevant. I hold a 2:1 LLB from UCL and an LLM in Comparative and International Dispute Resolution from Queen Mary, where I studied legal research, evidence analysis and international procedural law. My dissertation examined data protection law across jurisdictions, and a separate taught module on data privacy and governance received a mark of 75.

GUS operates across multiple jurisdictions and institutions, and the legal team's work will span a wide range of issues touching on regulatory compliance, contracts and institutional governance. That breadth is exactly what I am looking to develop into at paralegal level, building on the foundation I have in research, case management and drafting.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva